Soham Ratnaparkhi

Product Lead @ HydraDB · Founding Backend & Infra

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SUMMARY

Founding engineer turned Product Lead at **HydraDB** (**$6.5M seed**). Built backend and infra from day zero: hybrid vector + graph retrieval under **200ms**, **100k+ files/day** indexing, self-hosted Kubernetes production, and a graph DB from scratch targeting **10**× multi-hop vs Neo4j. IEEE-published; LFX / CNCF mentee.

EXPERIENCE

May 2026 – Present

Product Lead

Remote

HydraDB ($6.5M seed)

- **Promoted** after owning backend and infra from day zero on the team that raised a **$6.5M seed**.
- Lead product for HydraDB's context graph: roadmap, connectors, hybrid search, and DX for agents in production.
- Scaled connectors across **30+ SaaS tools**; hybrid search under **200ms**; SDKs on **npm + PyPI**.
- Building a **graph database from scratch** on object storage (OpenCypher + Bolt); ∼**10**× multi-hop vs Neo4j.

Jun 2025 – Present

Founding Backend & Infrastructure Engineer

Remote

HydraDB

- Sole owner of backend and infra from day zero; indexing at **100k+ files/day** (∼1M+ tokens/min).
- Self-hosted production on Kubernetes/EKS: Milvus, FalkorDB, ClickHouse, Kafka, Temporal, Prometheus, Grafana.
- Redesigned ingestion after production pain: Temporal, exactly-once inbox, per-org Kafka fairness, claim-check, replay-safe sinks.
- Migrated Kafka off silent-loss path (MSK Serverless → Strimzi KRaft); OpenAPI → SDKs; led usecortex.ai → hydradb.com.

Apr 2025 – Nov 2025

Founding Engineer

Remote

Findr AI → Cortex / HydraDB

- Built **Pro-Search** (production RAG + multi-step retrieval); cut p50/p90 latency **50%+**; accuracy ∼**20%**.

Aug 2024 – Nov 2024

Research Intern

Windsor, Canada

University of Windsor (Mitacs)

- Co-authored **IEEE** paper on privacy-preserving LLM fine-tuning (FL + blockchain + MPC); 52 models, 4 datasets; QLoRA.

Jun 2024 – Jul 2024

Technology Intern

Pune, India

Barclays

- Cut K8s fleet monitoring latency from **8 min to <1 min** (8×) across 1,000+ pods; dynamic query engine (27 filters).

Jun 2023 – Aug 2023

LFX Mentee

Remote

LitmusChaos (CNCF)

- Merged **7 PRs** (tests, interfaces, dedup); **90%+** coverage; GraphQL-to-REST migration on Go + Kubernetes.

PROJECTS

MindKeeper AI – personal second-brain RAG; 500k+ organic views

- Production RAG over personal/work data; multi-step retrieval; FastAPI, Go, Pinecone, Redis, AWS Lambda, Next.js.

Navigator AI – open-source browser automation agent

- Self-learning agent with custom DOM parsers (∼90% fewer tokens) and RAG memory; FastAPI, React, TypeScript, Weaviate.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Rust, TypeScript, Java
Backend / AI: FastAPI, Temporal, Kafka, RAG, OpenAPI, OpenCypher
Data stores: Milvus, FalkorDB, ClickHouse, PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB
Infra: Kubernetes, EKS, Helm, ArgoCD, Docker, AWS, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry

EDUCATION

2021 – 2025

B.Tech. Computer Engineering, Vishwakarma Institute of Technology, Pune
CGPA 9.29 / 10 (3.72 / 4)

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Founding eng → Product Lead @ HydraDB (**$6.5M seed**); YC India Startup School; LFX @ LitmusChaos (CNCF)
- **1st**, Google GenAI Hackathon 2024; ETHIndia 2022 & 2023, FVM Spacewarp; Mitacs Globalink (<15%); IEEE papers
- President, MLSC VIT — Hackspiration 2024 ($10k+ prize pool, 1,200+ participants)